

Activity Guide

Everything a facilitator needs to run the Cedarline Hybrid Mesh Firewall clinic — on one spread.

The mission

Today your team is the Cisco Solution Engineering team walking into Cedarline. You'll sit with four real conversations, hear what's keeping them up at night, and answer as SEs do: the right solution, why it fits, and the outcome it delivers — pulled together into one Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

The customer. Cedarline Health Group is a regional healthcare payer-provider — roughly 8,000 employees across four hospitals and thirty-one clinics, plus a claims-processing business that handles the money. Growth by acquisition (including a second data centre absorbed as-is) and a mid-flight, disorderly move to public cloud have left a fragmented security posture. After a security incident in March, the board asked what would have stopped it — and leadership still cannot answer. Budget and executive attention are approved, but explicitly temporary, and the security team is small.

Learning objectives

- 1 Map Cedarline's stated concerns to the right Cisco Secure solutions.
- 2 Explain, in the customer's language, how each solution addresses the concern.
- 3 Connect the four case studies into one coherent Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.
- 4 Present the outcome — the business result — not just the feature.

Built for every SE in the room

GENERALIST SES

Plain-language framing and a jargon decoder in the workbook mean no one needs a security background to contribute.

SECURITY SPECIALISTS

Depth cues and the specific Cisco capabilities keep specialists stretched — push them to the customer's real constraints.

The four case studies

- 1 **Case Study 1 — AI Security**
Cedarline is standing up AI across regulated workflows and public cloud faster than security can see it. Help them prove compliance, vet what they adopt, and get visibility and guardrails over AI traffic.
- 2 **Case Study 2 — Cloud Edge**
Workloads sprawl across AWS, Azure and on-prem, each with its own policy model. Contain lateral movement, prove consistent controls to auditors, and give Cedarline one place to define and enforce policy.
- 3 **Case Study 3 — DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall**
A mixed-vendor perimeter, an inherited rulebase and mostly-encrypted traffic leave blind spots and slow response. Restore visibility, speed the response, and modernise detection with the team they have.
- Case Study 4 — Macro & Micro Segmentation**

A flat data centre and fragmented Kubernetes networking invite east-west movement. Build segmentation Cedarline can adopt safely — with runtime visibility and application-dependency awareness so nothing breaks.

How to run it

- Teams of 3–5, mixing specialists and generalists. Each team gets a **Team Workbook**.
- Work all four case studies — four pain points each. For every one: the **product/platform** and the **SE response** (how it addresses the concern and the outcome).
- Finish by combining everything into one **Hybrid Mesh Firewall topology** — paste/draw it on the last page.
- Suggested timing: ~10 min per case study, ~15 min for the topology and readout.

How we evaluate — Good, Better, Best

Qualitative and encouraging — **no marks, no pass/fail**. Every answer sits on a growth ladder; facilitators name the level and coach one step up.

Good

NAMES THE FIT

You put the right Cisco solution on the table and show you understand what the customer is actually worried about.

Better

EXPLAINS THE HOW

You connect that solution to the concern — how it works and why it answers this specific problem — in language the customer would nod along to.

Best

SELLS THE OUTCOME

You tie it to Cedarline's real constraints and the business outcome they care about, and you place it inside the bigger Hybrid Mesh Firewall story.

Facilitators grade from the **Solution Guide** and record feedback on the **Proctor Grading Guide** — strengths first, then one growth nudge per case study.